R. Campbell Thompson, *The Epic of Gilgamish* (1928) – Tablet XI

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- **Title:** The Epic of Gilgamish. A new translation from a collation of the cuneiform tablets in the British Museum rendered literally into English hexameters
- **Translator:** Reginald Campbell Thompson (1876–1941)
- **Publisher/year:** London: Luzac & Co., 1928 (preface dated Nineveh, Christmas 1927)
- **URL used:** https://sacred-texts.com/ane/eog/eog13.htm (Tablet XI), eog00.htm (title), eog01.htm (preface). sacred-texts.com is behind a Cloudflare challenge, so the files were fetched from the Wayback Machine: `https://web.archive.org/web/2023id_/https://sacred-texts.com/ane/eog/eog13.htm`. A patron upload of a PDF also exists at https://archive.org/details/thompson-1928-gilgamesh (not downloaded).
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-16
- **License / copyright:** Public domain. Author died 1941, so it is PD in life+70 countries (UK, Israel, EU) since 2012. In the US, 1928 publications entered the public domain on 1 Jan 2024. The note on sacred-texts ("nominal US copyright") is out of date.

Files

- `sacred-texts_eog13_tablet-XI.raw.html`, `sacred-texts_eog00_title.raw.html`, `sacred-texts_eog01_preface.raw.html`: raw HTML (Windows-1252 entities).
- `tablet-XI.md`: clean UTF-8 extraction. `[5.]`, `[10.]` … are Thompson's marginal line numbers (every fifth Akkadian line). `[^n]` marks footnote anchors, and the footnotes follow at the end as `page:n`. "p. 50" etc. are page breaks.

Line numbering

Thompson's English hexameters do **not** run one-to-one with Akkadian lines. The marginal numbers give the Akkadian line count of his own 1930 edition, which is close to the older Haupt/Thompson numbering. Compared with George (BGE 2003 / eBL):

- Same at the start: Thompson 1–~95 ≈ George 1–~95.

- Behind by ~1–3 lines in the 140s–150s: Nisir at Thompson 140 vs George 141–146 (Nimuš); dove at Thompson 145 vs George 148.
- Behind by ~8–10 lines by 190–200: "mouth of the rivers" at Thompson 195 vs George 205–206.
- Misprint on sacred-texts: "[150.]" after [175.] should be [180.].

Assessment

Thompson re-collated the tablets himself, and the brackets mark restorations and additions exactly. The English hexameter is stilted, archaising "Bible English" (thee/thou, "hath"). The names use old readings: Shurippak, Ubara-Tutu, Ninurta, Nisir (now Nimuš), Puzur-Amurri (George reads Puzur-Enlil, from the logogram ^{d}KUR.GAL), Irragal. It is outdated philologically (pre-1930 lexicon, gaps now filled by Assur, Babylon and Nimrud manuscripts). It is still useful as a historical reading and as a literal, bracket-marked witness to how the text was understood c. 1930.